

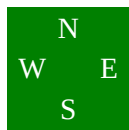
**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3  
 ♥ 6 5 2  
 ♦ Q 10 5 2  
 ♣ K Q 9 3

♠ A 10  
 ♥ A K Q J 9  
 ♦ K 4 3  
 ♣ 7 5 2



♠ K Q J 7 4  
 ♥ 10 3  
 ♦ J 8 7  
 ♣ J 10 4

♠ 9 8 6 2  
 ♥ 8 7 4  
 ♦ A 9 6  
 ♣ A 8 6

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♥    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass     | 3♣    | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by North

**HELP SUIT GAME TRY.** Partner has 8 points and the ♣A and decides that is enough to bid game.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You win the ♠A and pull trumps in three rounds. You need to manufacture one winner and you can see right off the bat that it cannot be manufactured in ♦s or ♣s. However, you **CAN** set up the ♠8.

Lead the ♠10. East must win with his ♠J. Let's say he plays a ♣. Win with dummy's ♣A and play the ♠9, discarding a small ♣. East will take his ♠Q and cash a ♣ trick, but then must let you back in. You enter dummy with the ♦A and discard your ♦ loser on the good ♠8.

It is extra nice when the opponents hand you a contract.

You cannot make 10 tricks unless East's opening lead is a ♠.

Your first bid is easy, you say 1♥. But what do you say after partner's 2♥ response?

You have 18 points and partner has 6-10. Doing the math, you total 24-28.

You want to make a bid that will tell partner to bid game if he has 9-10, but will stop at 3♥ if he only has 6-7. Lots of players will bid 3♥ with this hand to make just that invitation. There's nothing wrong with that bid.

But there is an improvement. Bid 3♣ instead. Partner knows you aren't showing him a ♣ suit, why would you do that after agreeing on ♥s? What it means is "Partner I'm inviting you to bid the game if you have maximum, but if your decision is close decide based on ♣s, the suit I could use help in." It is called a

**Board 2**

North Deals

None Vul

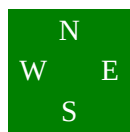
♠ 3  
♥ Q J 10 6 2  
♦ 10 8  
♣ K J 9 5 3

♠ A J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ A K 7 4 2

♣ 6 2



♠ 10

♥ K 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ Q 10 7 4

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

♥ A 4

♦ 6 3

♣ A 8

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♦    | Pass | 1♠    |
| Pass     | 2♠    | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass     | 3♦    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass     | 5♥    | Pass | 6♠    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6♠ by South

you aren't bidding a ♣ suit, he knows you have already agreed on ♠s. He will take you to be showing first round control in ♣s, probably the ♣A.

Partner bids 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ is a control bid showing the ♦A. Do not even consider that he is trying to get back to ♦s, you both know that your suit is ♠s.

**NOW** you use Blackwood, knowing you are not in danger of losing two quick ♦s.

Partner replies 5♥, showing two Aces.

Your side has all the Aces but don't get greedy. Remember that partner made a minimum bid at his second turn. He couldn't have two Aces and three Kings.

So you bid the small slam.

South plays 6♠. West leads the ♥Q.

**South plays 6♠. West leads the ♥Q.**

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 2

Too bad partner didn't have either ♥K or ♣K. But since he didn't you will just have to establish the ♦ suit.

You pull trumps in one round with your ♠K. Play ♦ A K, then ruff a ♦. if both defenders follow then both dummy's ♦s are good and you will make 7. However, it is more likely that ♦s will split 4-2, in which case you return to dummy with the ♠J and ruff the fourth ♦. Back to dummy with the ♠A and play the now-established ♦7, discarding either your ♥ or ♣ loser.

Establishing a long side suit in dummy is one of the basic ways to eliminate a loser.

In this hand you could not be defeated unless the ♦s split 5-1.

You don't quite have the strength for a jump-shift, and in any case sometimes it is better to proceed slowly. So you respond 1♠, knowing partner must bid again.

He does bid again, surprising you when he says 2♠.

All of a sudden your hand has become gigantic. Never mind points, you have only 5 possible losers in your hand and partner has opened the bidding. Surely he can take care of a few of them.

You want to try for slam. **DO NOT BID**

**BLACKWOOD!** With two quick losers in ♦s you would not know what to do if Partner showed only one Ace. You wouldn't know whether the defense could take the first two ♦ tricks or not. A better approach is to use a control bid.

So you bid 3♣. Partner will absolutely know that

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 7 5  
♥ 9 7 4  
♦ Q 10 5  
♣ A Q 7 3

♠ 9 2

♥ K Q J 10 6 3

♦ 8 3

♣ 9 6 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q J 10 6  
♥ 8  
♦ K J 9 4  
♣ J 10 8 5

♠ A K 4 3

♥ A 5 2

♦ A 7 6 2

♣ K 4

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Wow! Partner opens with a 2-bid and you have all of this?

Don't get carried away, it was a **WEAK** 2-bid. So even though you have 19 points partner has only 6-11. But even though it is possible that the total only comes to 25 you bid the game anyway, figuring that it will probably be at least 26.

South would play 4♥.

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North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠Q.

**North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠Q.**

There are two ways to get rid of one of those ♣ losers. You can lead up to the ♣K, hoping that East holds ♣A, or you can ruff it in dummy.

Suppose you try to combine both chances. Win the ♠K, then play a small ♥ to your hand. Lead a ♣ and play dummy's ♣K. West takes the ♣A and plays another trump which you win in your hand. You play another ♣ but West wins this one also and leads another trump, removing dummy's last hope of ruffing a ♣. Down 1.

Instead you could give up on the idea of leading toward the ♣K and just lead a ♣ from dummy at trick 2. The defenders can win and lead a trump, but you play a second ♣. They win this also but even if they lead a trump you can still ruff your third ♣ in dummy and make the game.

You can see that playing a ♣ from dummy will guarantee the contract.

You can also see that leading a ♥ back to your hand at trick 2 is a bad idea.

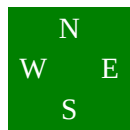
But did you see there is another way to reach your hand? You could play ♠A then ruff a ♠. This runs the small risk that West started with a singleton ♠.

**Board 4**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ 7 5 3  
♥ Q 10 7 6  
♦ K Q J  
♣ Q 10 8

♠ Q 9 2  
♥ 8 5 4  
♦ A 6 3  
♣ 7 5 4 2



♠ A 6  
♥ J 9  
♦ 10 8 7 4 2  
♣ K J 9 3

♠ K J 10 8 4  
♥ A K 3 2  
♦ 9 5  
♣ A 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 2 ♠   | Pass | 3 ♦   |
| Pass         | 3 ♠   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3 ♠ by South |       |      |       |

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The ♦ loser, the ♣ loser and the Ace of trumps are unavoidable. One ♥ loser is also unavoidable, but the second one can be ruffed in dummy. You cannot afford to play a single trump.

Win the ♦ A and play ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ 2. The defenders will win this. If your ♥ 3 happened to set up then you won't have to ruff it, but more than likely the ♥ s split 4-2. The defenders may now take a ♦ winner, or they may lead ♠ A and another ♠. But they cannot stop you from ruffing your fourth ♥ with dummy's ♠ Q or ♠ 9.

The defenders may not lead trumps to try to stop your ruff.

In that case you must be sure to ruff the fourth ♥ with the ♠ Q or the ♠ 9. If East wants to over-ruff it will be with the ♠ A which you must lose anyway.

Look at what would have happened if you had led a trump at trick 2. East could have won the ♠ A and played another ♠. Then, when West took the third ♥ he could lead his last ♠ and dummy would have no trump to ruff the final ♥ with.

With 6 points you must respond. And with 3 ♠ s you can support partner's suit.

You respond 2 ♠ and partner bids 3 ♦.

Partner's 3 ♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try. He is inviting you to bid game if you have a good 2 ♠ response, particularly if you can help him in ♦ s.

Although have the ♦ help you have a bare minimum response. So you return to 3 ♠ which partner passes.

North would play 3 ♠.

Click

South plays 3 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.

**South plays 3 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.**